was the value system and traditions of [the] Tatas set by the founder, embodied in the manner and style in which Mr JRD Tata led the Tata group'. He then proposed that JRD be appointed 'Chairman Emeritus of the Board of Tata Sons in recognition of his outstanding contribution'.

The change was epochal. History was made. Eighty-six-year-old J.R.D. Tata, the most recognized and celebrated industrialist of India, had just stepped down after spending sixty-nine years in the group. Simultaneously, he had handed over the reins of the largest private business conglomerate in the country with a turnover of Rs 10,000 crore to Ratan Tata.

Predictably, Ratan's appointment did not go down well with the veterans. The disappointment of the old guards at having lost out was portentous. Ratan's position, to many, looked vulnerable.